

The Media

Speaking Part 1

Imagine that you are preparing a project with your friend. You have found some interesting material for the presentation and you want to read this text to your friend. You have 1.5 minutes to read the text silently, then be ready to read it out aloud. You will not have more than 1.5 minutes to read it.

Media in Russia has a long history dating back to the 19th century. However, it wasn't until the Soviet era that it truly began to develop. The Soviet government heavily controlled and censored the media, using it as a tool for propaganda. With the collapse of the Soviet Union in 1991, media in Russia began to change and private media companies emerged. Today, media in Russia is a mix of state-controlled and privately owned outlets. State-controlled media have a strong presence, but privately owned media outlets have also gained popularity. The internet has also played a significant role in the development of media in Russia. Despite the challenges in terms of censorship and government control, the media in Russia has undergone significant changes throughout its history, becoming more diverse and free press today, with an increasing number of private media companies and online platforms providing a wider range of news and information for citizens.

Speaking Part 2. Task 1

Study the advertisement.

Take out a subscription to our new magazine!



You are considering taking out a subscription to a new magazine and now you'd like to get more information. In 1.5 minutes you are to ask four direct questions to find out about the following:

1. price;
2. delivery options;
3. number of issues a month;
4. readership.

You have 20 seconds to ask each question.

Speaking Part 2. Task 2

Study the advertisement.

Watch top-quality movies with no ads!



You are considering buying a film online and now you'd like to get more information. In 1.5 minutes you are to ask four direct questions to find out about the following:

1. discounts for a monthly fee
2. time available
3. quality
4. downloading

You have 20 seconds to ask each question.

Speaking Part 3. Task 1

You are going to give an interview. You have to answer five questions. Give full answers to the questions (2-3 sentences).

Remember that you have 40 seconds to answer each question.

Tapescript for Task 3

Interviewer: Hello everybody! It's *Teenagers Round the World* Channel. Our guest today is a teenager from Russia and we are going to discuss the Media. We'd like to know our guest's point of view on this issue. Please answer five questions. So, let's get started.

Interviewer: How effective are different types of media in communicating information and ideas?

Student: _____

Interviewer: Do you use all types of media?

Student: _____

Interviewer: What newspapers do you read? What is your definition of a "good newspaper"?

Student: _____

Interviewer: What are your favourite radio and TV programmes?

Student: _____

Interviewer: How often do you use the Internet? What are your main reasons for using it?

Student: _____

Interviewer: Thank you very much for your interview.

Suggested answers for Speaking Part 2. Task 1:

1. How much is the subscription to your new magazine?
2. What are the delivery options?
3. How many issues can I buy a month? \ How many issues are there a month?
4. How many people read your magazine? \ What type of people usually read your magazine?

Suggested answers for Speaking Part 2. Task 2:

1. Are there any discounts for a monthly fee if I buy this film?
2. How long can I watch this film if I buy an online version?
3. What quality is available?
4. Will I be able to download this film? Can I download this film after I've bought it?

Suggested answers for Speaking Part 3. Task 1:

1. I believe the internet is the most effective one. You can check any information and when you misunderstand something, you may also use pictures or read articles or watch bloggers explaining things to you.
2. I never read newspapers. I think they are the things of the past. I rarely listen to the radio. As for television and the internet, I use them daily.
3. As I've already said, I hardly ever read newspapers. But if I need to read something reliable, I buy "Russian newspaper". A good newspaper is a reliable one.
4. I like watching Animal Planet on TV. I usually watch different programmes on how animals live. I rarely listen to the radio but if I do, the best programme for me is Real Theatre.
5. I use the Internet daily. It's quick, you can find almost any information there and you can also get in touch with anyone within seconds.

Speaking Part 3. Task 2

Interviewer: Hello! It's *Teenagers Round the World* Channel and today we are going to discuss watching TV – now and then. Our guest today is a teenager from Russia. We'd like to know what you watched on TV when you were seven and what TV programmes you watch now. Please answer five questions. So, let's get started.

Interviewer: Do you think watching TV is a good way to spend your free time or not? Why do you think so?

Student: _____

Interviewer: What can you tell us about some of the TV programmes you like?

Student: _____

Interviewer: What did you use to watch on TV when you were seven?

Student: _____

Interviewer: How did you use TV for self-education?

Student: _____

Interviewer: What TV programmes would you like to appear in the near future?

Student: _____

Interviewer: Thank you very much for your interview.

Speaking Part 4. Task 1

Imagine that you and your friend are doing a school project "Communication with friends". You have found some photos to illustrate it but for technical reasons you cannot send them now. Leave a voice message to your friend explaining your choice of the photos and sharing some ideas about the project. In 2.5 minutes be ready to:

- explain the choice of the illustrations for the project by briefly describing them and noting the differences;
- mention the advantages (1–2) of the two ways of communication with friends;
- mention the disadvantages (1–2) of the two ways of communication with friends;
- express your opinion on the subject of the project – which way of communication presented in the pictures you prefer and why.

You will speak for not more than 3 minutes (12–15 sentences). You have to talk continuously.



Find grammar and lexical mistakes in the following answer:

Hi Sasha, I've found two pictures for our project "Communication with friends" and I want to tell you about them

In the first picture, there are people who using mobile phones. I think they are watching social network sites, liking posts and writing comments. In the second picture, there's a group of friends chatting. They are sitting in circle on the floor. I think they are having a live discussion. There is an obvious difference between the pictures: in the first one, the people communicate using a digital device whereas in the second photo, it's a real-life discussion.

I believe there are lots of advantages of communicating with friends using both of the ways that I've mentioned. You can get in touch with your friend wherever you are if you will use your phone. Offline communication brings positive emotions and makes bonds more stronger.

Speaking about the drawsides of the two ways of communication with friends, I want to say that it's sometimes hard to understand what other person feels if you text or write emails. As for real-life discussions, it's hard to hide your feelings. For example, when you go bored and you don't want to offend other people. Your friends will probably recognise that and may become sad.

Personally, I prefer talking to my friends offline. I like seeing emotions, be able to hug my friends when I see them and when we say goodbye each other. Real-life communication makes me happy.

That's all I wanted to tell you about the pictures for the project and my opinion. Call me back.

Answers for Speaking Part 4. Task 1:

Hi Sasha, I've found two pictures for our project "Communication with friends" and I want to tell you about them

In the first picture, there are people who are using mobile phones. I think they are watching browsing social network sites; liking posts and writing comments. In the second picture, there's a group of friends chatting. They are sitting in a circle on the floor. I think they are having a live lively discussion. There is an obvious difference between the pictures: in the first one, the people are communicating using a digital device whereas in the second photo, it's a real-life discussion.

I believe there are lots of advantages of communicating with friends using both of the ways that I've mentioned. You can get in touch with your friend wherever you are if you will use your phone. Offline communication brings positive emotions and makes bonds more (much) stronger.

Speaking about the ~~drawsides~~ downsides\drawbacks of the two ways of communication with friends, I want to say that it's sometimes hard to understand what other another person feels if you text or write emails. As for real-life discussions, it's hard to hide your feelings. For example, when you go get bored and you don't want to offend other people. Your friends will probably recognise that and may become sad.

Personally, I prefer talking to my friends offline. I like seeing emotions, be being able to hug my friends when I see them and when we say goodbye to each other. Real-life communication makes me happy.

That's all I wanted to tell you about the pictures for the project and my opinion. Call me back.

Suggested answers for Speaking Part 3. Task 2:

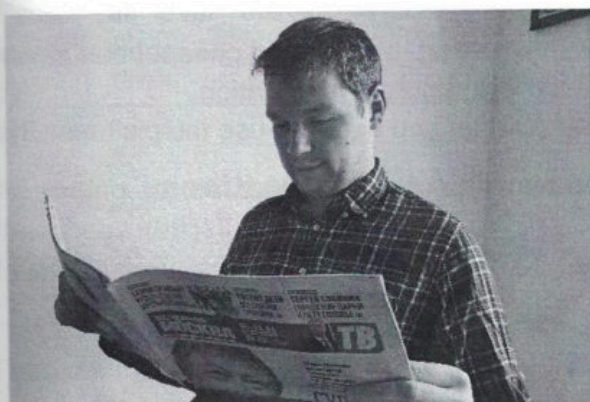
1. I don't think watching TV is a good way to spend my free time. I don't think modern programmes are very educational. You can learn much more by reading books or watching special programmes on Rutube.
2. I like watching programmes about animals. My favourite TV programme is 'Nat Geo Wild.' It's very interesting to look at wild animals' behaviour. This programme is on twice a week and I always watch it.
3. When I was seven, I used to watch cartoons. I could watch them all day long. Now, I'm not interested in this kind of programme.
4. I used to watch a lot of programmes about science. They were quite fascinating and educational. When I was a child, I also watched 'Fixiki' and learned a lot about our world.
5. I think it will be interesting if programmes about modern scientific inventions appear in the near future. I would also like to watch reality shows where people and robots live together.

Speaking Part 4. Task 2

Imagine that you and your friend are doing a school project "Ways of getting news". You have found some photos to illustrate it but for technical reasons you cannot send them now. Leave a voice message to your friend explaining your choice of the photos and sharing some ideas about the project. In 2.5 minutes be ready to:

- explain the choice of the illustrations for the project by briefly describing them and noting the differences;
- mention the advantages (1–2) of the two types of media;
- mention the disadvantages (1–2) of the two types of media;
- express your opinion on the subject of the project – which type of getting information presented in the pictures you prefer and why.

You will speak for not more than 3 minutes (12–15 sentences). You have to talk continuously.



Writing an email. Asking questions

Read the following sentences from emails. Make up questions that you could ask.

I watched a new comedy with my sister yesterday evening. We laughed a lot.

Ask 3 questions about the comedy:

- 1) _____
- 2) _____
- 3) _____

I'm going to register on a new social network.

Ask 3 questions about the new social network.

- 1) _____
- 2) _____
- 3) _____

Ask 3 questions about his intention to register on a new social network.

- 1) _____
- 2) _____
- 3) _____

Sample answers for Speaking Part 4. Task 2:

Hi Pasha, I found two appropriate pictures for our project "Ways of getting news".

I think we should use the pictures because they illustrate two different ways of getting news. In the first one, I can see a man reading a newspaper. He seems to be very interested. The second picture depicts a woman, sitting on a coach with a notebook on her lap. I suppose she's reading news on the internet but I cannot see what is on screen. The difference between the pictures is obvious. The man is reading a real newspaper, whereas the woman is using an electronic device.

There are a few advantages of using both of the types of media. If you read a real newspaper, you feel the paper. Many people also like the smell of freshly printed publication. As for reading news on the internet, it's always up to date and you can get the latest news within a second. Moreover, you can even watch a video that is related to a piece of news.

Unfortunately, the two types of media also have some disadvantages. Once you've read a newspaper, you don't need it, so it becomes trash. There are tons of newspapers thrown away daily around the world. In addition, newspapers do not represent the latest news as they are printed the next day. Speaking about the internet, the downside is that there could be some fake news that usually spread quite quickly.

Personally, I prefer getting information via the internet. It's fast and cheap. I can always check websites for reliability and make sure that I get accurate information.

That's all for now. Call me back and tell me whether you agree to use the pictures. Bye.

Suggested answers for Writing an email. Asking questions

Comedy:

1. How long was the comedy?
2. Are there any stars in the film?
3. What is the plot?

The question 'Was it funny?' is inappropriate since your friend says 'We laughed a lot.'

A new social network:

1. What's the name of this social network?
2. Is there a tablet version?
3. What kind of social network is it?

His intention to register on a new social network:

1. Why do you want to register?
2. Are you going to share anything there or will you just look?
3. Has anyone influenced your choice?

Writing an email. Task 2

You have received an email message from your English-speaking pen-friend Diana:

From: Diana@mail.uk
To: Russian_friend@ege.ru
Subject: Media
... I like spending time reading Moscow news and I'm going to get a new magazine tomorrow. Where do you usually get news from? Do you often read a newspaper? Would you like to be a journalist, why or why not? My brother Jonatan wrote an article for a famous newspaper...

Write an email to Diana.

In your message:

-answer her questions;

-ask 3 questions about her brother.

Write **100–140 words**.

Remember the rules of email writing.

Writing Task 38. Task 1

Fill in the gap with the following words and phrases. Some words or phrases should be used more than once

a third	communication	face to face	voice	means	convenient
utmost	misunderstanding	communicate	the youth	twice	go dead
logical	body language	strengthens	them	relevant	connection

People all over the world 1) _____ with each other daily by using various 2) _____. I am now doing a project on the ways of 3) _____ preferred by Zetland teenagers. I have found some results of a 4) _____ survey in the form of a pie chart.

According to the data, the teenagers prefer to talk to other people by speaking on the phone (36%). Almost 5) _____ of the respondents say that their favourite way is talking in person (27%). Only 7% of 6) _____ send _____ messages.

Predictably, 7) _____ as many of young people in the teenagers 8) _____ via texting (20%) as those who send emails (10%). It seems to be 9) logical as modern teenagers use their phones almost all the time and there are many texting apps that they can use. These apps seem to be much more 10) _____ than mail apps.

Unfortunately, there are a few problems that can arise while communicating through technical devices. The 11) _____ could be bad or the battery may 12) _____. This may lead to some 13) _____. To solve the problem, one should always have a power bank with 14) _____ to recharge their technical devices and continue interaction.

In conclusion, I believe that communicating in person is of 15) _____ importance for people. They can see people's 16) _____ and emotions and understand each other better if they communicate 17) _____. In addition, real-life communication 18) _____ bonds between people.

237 words

Sample answer for Writing an email. Task 2

Hi Diana,

Thanks for your email! It's so great to hear from you again. How's it going?

In your email you asked me about getting news. Well, I'm not really interested in what's going on in the world, but I sometimes read news on the Internet. In fact, I never read any newspapers or magazines and I've never been into it. I've never wished to become a journalist. It's not my cup of tea.

Anyway, tell me about your brother. How old is he? Did he write an article as part of his job? Where does he work?

I have to go now to help my mum cook dinner. Keep in touch!

Best wishes,

Julia

(113 words)

Answers for Writing Task 38. Task 1:

People all over the world 1) communicate with each other daily by using various 2) means. I am now doing a project on the ways of 3) communication preferred by Zetland teenagers. I have found some results of a 4) relevant survey in the form of a pie chart.

According to the data, the young people prefer to talk to other people by speaking on the phone (36%). Almost 5) a third of the respondents say that their favourite way is talking in person (27%). Only 7% of 6) the youth send voice messages.

Predictably, 7) twice as many of the teenagers 8) communicate via texting (20%) as those who send emails (10%). It seems to be 9) logical as modern teenagers use their phones almost all the time and there are many texting apps that they can use. These apps seem to be much more 10) convenient than mail apps.

Unfortunately, there are a few problems that can arise while communicating through technical devices. The 11) connection could be bad or the battery may 12) go dead. This may lead to some 13) misunderstanding. To solve the problem, one should always have a power bank with 14) them to recharge their technical devices and continue interaction.

In conclusion, I believe that communicating in person is of 15) utmost importance for people. They can see people's 16) body language and emotions and understand each other better if they communicate 17) face to face. In addition, real-life communication 18) strengthens bonds between people.

237words

Writing Task 38. Problems and solutions

Match the tasks to the problems that people can face. There could be a few problems that correspond to a task.

A problem that can arise with...	Problem	Solution
1. ways of getting information		
2. using social media sites		
3. getting information		

Problems:

People waste a great deal of time using them.

Unfortunately, there is a great deal of wrong information on the Internet.

People may find friends who are not suitable for them or there could be people who can deceive them.

Unfortunately, if people rely only on the Internet when getting information, they could be deceived easily. Some websites could be edited by ordinary people, who may introduce their own opinion as facts.

Some people use such websites so often that they have become addicted to them.

Now match the solutions to the problems. There may be a few solutions to different problems.

It is important that schools teach their students how to check websites for reliability. Adults can also find some programmes that teach that. It is also a good idea to check different sources to find out whether the information is right or wrong.

To tackle this problem, one should try to install special programs that will track the time a person has spent on the website and remind the person to do something else.

To tackle the problem, schools could organise special classes for students to teach them not to give personal data to people they do not know personally, even if they seem fine on the Internet.

To solve the problem, people should check different sources of information to figure out the truth. It is also advisable to read books on the subject instead of searching for pieces of information on the Internet.

People can address this problem by limiting the time spent on such websites. Instead, it is better to go for a walk with your friends in the open air.

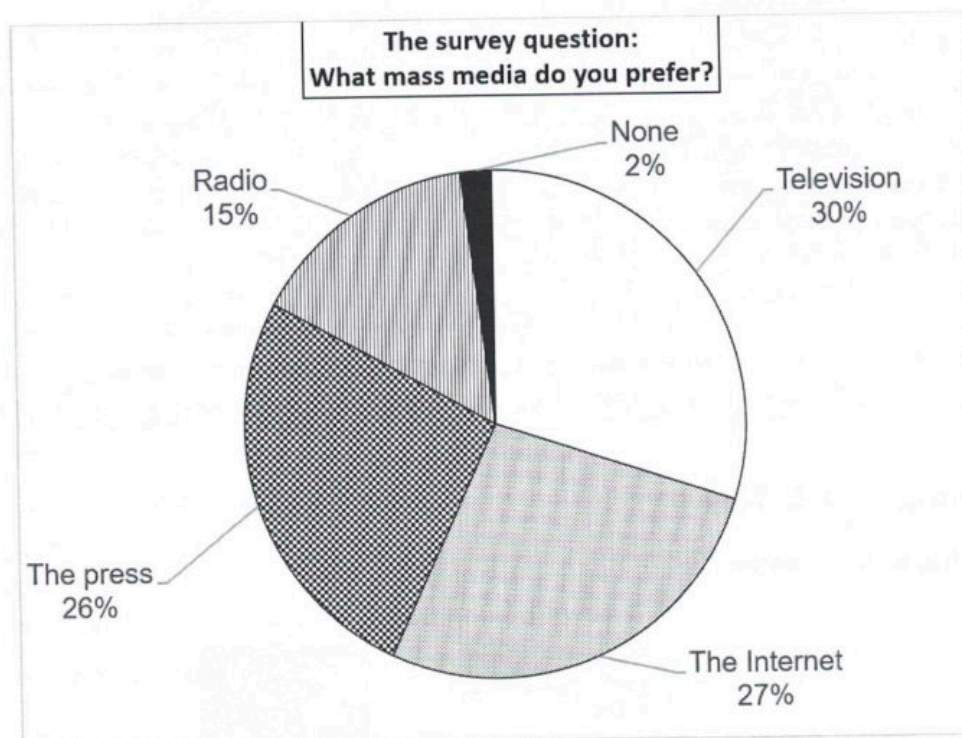
Answers for Writing Task 38. Problems and solutions

A problem that can arise with...	Problem	Solution
1. ways of getting information	Unfortunately, if people rely only on the Internet when getting information, they could be deceived easily. Some websites could be edited by ordinary people, who may introduce their own opinion as facts.	It is important that schools teach their students how to check websites for reliability. Adults can also find some programmes that teach that. It is also a good idea to check different sources to find out whether the information is right or wrong.
2. using social media sites	1) People waste a great deal of time using them. 2) People may find friends who are not suitable for them or there could be people who can deceive them. 3) Some people use such websites so often that they have become addicted to them.	1, 3) To tackle this problem, one should try to install special programs that will track the time a person has spent on the website and remind the person to do something else. 2) To tackle the problem, schools could organise special classes for students to teach them not to give personal data to people they do not know personally, even if they seem fine on the Internet. 3, 1) People can address this problem by limiting the time spent on such websites. Instead, it is better to go for a walk with your friends in the open air.
3. getting information	Unfortunately, there is a great deal of wrong information on the Internet.	To solve the problem, people should check different sources of information to figure out the truth. It is also advisable to read books on the subject instead of searching for pieces of information on the Internet.

Writing Task 38. Task 3 (Sample answer on page 175)

Imagine that you are doing a project on popular mass media with teenagers in Zetland. You have found some data on the subject – the results of a survey (see the pie chart below).

Comment on the survey data and give your opinion on the subject of the project.



Write 200–250 words.

Use the following plan:

- make an opening statement on the subject of the project;
- select and report 2–3 facts;
- make 1–2 comparisons where relevant and give your comments;
- outline a problem that one can face trusting media sources and suggest a way of solving it;
- conclude by giving and explaining your opinion on the role of the media in our lives.